

Tulåh Wellness Clinic luxury wellness sanctuary located in Kerala that combines Ayurveda with modern medicine

price, rarity and ownership to encompass access, personalisation, service and experience," says Pushpa Bector, Group Executive Director and Business Head, DLF Retail.

For Bector, luxury retail destinations are no longer defined by brands they house. Architecture, dining, cultural programming, hospitality and exclusive customer interactions increasingly add to their appeal. At DLF Emporio in New Delhi, the luxury ecosystem spans 103 brands and restaurants, including 45 international luxury brands and 54 Indian designers. The Chanakya in New Delhi houses 39 brands and experiences. DLF Luxury Malls have recorded an average 24% year-on-year increase in sales.

The changing approach was evident at DLF Emporio's 'Treasury of Trousseau' in September, which brought together nine showcases featuring designers and brands including Tarun Tahiliani, Gaurav Gupta, Arpita Mehta and Baccarat. The programme incorporated intimate lunches, designer conversations and exclusive collection unveilings.

The stores are changing, too. Gucci has expanded its presence at DLF Emporio with a dedicated environment for important clients, while Chanel has created a more immersive space at The Chanakya. "Luxury is also converging with gastronomy, art, culture, design, wellness and hospitality," says Bector.

The objective is to give consumers reasons to visit, engage and return, even when they are not immediately looking to make a purchase.

For luxury brands, the challenge is no longer just to sell something desirable, but to create something worth remembering. In a market where the wealthy can buy almost anything, the real differentiator may be the experiences that money can buy—but few others can access. BT